

Stop or deallocate nodes with Scale-down mode

- By default, AKS nodes are removed during scale down and new nodes are provisioned during scale up
- You can choose to delete or deallocate nodes in your AKS cluster after a scale down operation using **Scale-down mode** feature. **Delete** mode is the default
- The other option is **Deallocate** mode
- The decision to choose between Delete or Deallocate mode is based on the time needed to get the node ready to serve your workload
- With Deallocate mode, nodes are stopped instead of removed, resulting in faster scaling operations and preserving container images on the node
 - Deallocate mode can result in additional charges for operating system and data storage disks attached to the VM
 - Nodes in Deallocate mode appear as NotReady after scaling down
 - Ephemeral OS Disks are not supported for Deallocate mode
 - A node pool can be created with any scale down mode, and the scale-down mode can be updated after creation
 - Switching from Deallocate to Delete mode removes deallocated nodes